

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3207

Name

Daniela Sequeira

Email

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Gender

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Zürich, Switzerland

Nationality

Portuguese

When did or will you finish your PhD?

Summer 2023

University Education

Ph.D. | Molecular Life Sciences|University of Zurich, Switzerland|2018-present

Master| Medical Microbiology| Universidade Nova de Lisboa, Portugal|2013-2015

Bachelor| Molecular and Cellular Biology|Universidade Nova de Lisboa, Portugal|2010-2013

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I used to be absolutely sure that I loved Science.

That's why I did all the conventional ladder: BSc, MSc and Ph.D. I finally realized that the world of Academia doesn't fit me and where I'm best and feel at my best is when I talk to people and make something happen. Running experiments and doing lab work just wasn't doing it for me at some point in

my academic journey. And, heartbreakingly, I thought I didn't love Science anymore. Until I joined the "Native Scientists".

Prepping material and preparing myself to speak for a lay audience and conducting the workshop made me realize that I absolutely enjoy talking about Science and sharing knowledge. This experience pushed me out of my comfort Academic zone just to show me that I don't need to be an Academic to be part of Science. And even if pipetting isn't the real deal for me, I can see the potential of Science Outreach and Education to fulfill me personally and professionally.

Therefore, I would be thrilled and humbled to take a Science Corps fellowship, engaging with students, supporting and expanding innovative projects by sharing my expertise. My ultimate goal is that, at the end of the curriculum, my students will be thirstier for knowledge and more empowered to follow any professional path they wish to challenge themselves with.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

The first experience I had with communicating Science to a younger audience started in 2018 when I volunteered as a tutor in the organization "Skype a Scientist". There I tutored classes of 1st and 8th graders, by explaining basic concepts in Microbiology and Immunology. It was the most rewarding experience and I received the most fun and smart questions from the pupils.

In 2021, I founded the "Native Scientists" workshops in Zurich becoming an official Coordinator. My role includes building a network of Portuguese-speaking scientists, recruiting scientists and teachers, and planning the annual strategy in Zurich to organize science workshops for children from underserved migrant communities. Since then my deliverables included organizing the first-ever workshop in Zurich, acquiring coordinators for different cities, expanding our network to 5 cities, reaching 100 pupils.

During my research stays at ETH and the University of Zurich, I was also a teaching assistant. The teaching assignments included preparing scientific protocols and directly supervising BSc and MSc students for several weeks, during practical laboratory work, following biosafety guidelines. During the courses, I was also responsible for guiding the students on their preparation for the oral exams and presentations, including grading.

In 2021, I was given the responsibility to directly supervise a MSc student from a top University in France for a 5-month internship where we developed novel tools to study Human Adenovirus infection in mammalian cells.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In the near future, I consider taking a role in Scientific Communication in industry or Science outreach at a University or other organization. I would very much like to contribute to Medical and Science awareness either to the scientific or lay audience.

Regarding the long-term future, I envision myself switching gears and working for a non-profit organization, developing educational programs for schools and universities, thereby contributing to building bridges between scientists and students. My dream would be to work for National Geographic or Greenpeace.

CV/Resume[ScienceCorps_DSequeira.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

I would like to start the Fellowship in November 2023 in Tangier.

[Science Corps](#)